

Citrix Zero-Day Bug Allows Unauthenticated RCE

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- Published: 2024-11-12
- Original: <https://www.darkreading.com/cloud-security/citrix-recording-manager-zero-day-bug-unauthenticated-rce>
- Preserved from: <https://www.darkreading.com/cloud-security/citrix-recording-manager-zero-day-bug-unauthenticated-rce> (preserved-copy) on 2026-08-04
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[Tara Seals](#) ,Managing Editor, News ,Dark Reading

November 12, 2024

2 Min Read



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[Ed. note, Nov. 12 at 12:30 p.m. ET: Citrix has now issued patches for the issue and assigned CVE-2024-8068/CVE-2024-8069 for tracking.]

An unpatched zero-day [vulnerability in Citrix's Session Recording Manager](#) allows unauthenticated remote code execution (RCE, paving the way for data theft, lateral movement, and desktop takeover).

According to watchTowr research out today, the issue (which does not yet have a CVE or [C VSS score](#)) resides in Citrix's Session Recording Manager, which, as its name implies, records user activity, including keyboard and mouse inputs, websites visited, video streams of desktop activity, and more.

"Citrix advertises the feature as being really useful for monitoring (somewhat obviously), but also for compliance and troubleshooting. It can even be set up so that certain actions (like identifying sensitive data) will trigger recording, which helps meet regulatory needs and flag suspicious activities," the watchTowr researchers noted in the [report](#).

The feature logs session recordings via Microsoft Message Queuing (MSMQ), which enables efficient data transfer from individual computers to centralized storage. However, the Citrix implementation uses BinaryFormatter for serialization and deserialization of the information for easier and more accurate transfer and storage. The utility is unfortunately well-known [to be insecure](#).

BinaryFormatter is a .NET class created by Microsoft, which is in the process of deprecating it: "BinaryFormatter is insecure and can't be made secure. Applications should stop using [it] as soon as possible, even if they believe the data they're processing to be trustworthy," the computing giant [said](#) in August.

On top of the BinaryFormatter issue, Recording Session Manager also involves an exposed MSMQ service that can be reached from any host via HTTP. This, combined with what watchTowr says are misconfigured permissions, paves the way for unauthenticated RCE.

Dark Reading has reached out for comment and planned patching or mitigation information from both watchTowr and Citrix. There is no evidence of in-the-wild exploitation yet, but given [Citrix's attractiveness as a cybercrime target](#), that could soon change.

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About the Author



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Tara Seals

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Tara Seals is an award-winning journalist with 25+ years of experience as a reporter, analyst, and editor in the cybersecurity, communications, and technology spaces. As managing editor, she runs the newsroom at Dark Reading, leading a team of staff writers and freelance contributors. She also heads up strategy for a variety of in-depth, multichannel news coverage initiatives.

Prior to joining Dark Reading in 2022, Tara was editor-in-chief at cybersecurity stalwart Threatpost, and prior to that, the North American news lead for Infosecurity Magazine. She also spent 13 years working for other titles at Virgo Publishing (now part of Informa TechTarget), as executive editor and editor-in-chief at publications focused on communications service providers, channel partners, and enterprise mobile and video technology. In 2026, she was awarded a regional Azbee award for her in-depth coverage of the ongoing North Korean fake worker cyber campaign.

A Texas native, she holds a B.A. from Columbia University, lives in Western Massachusetts with her family, and is on a never-ending quest for good Mexican food in the Northeast.

[See more from Tara Seals](#)

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